- Beans and peas are high in fibre. Fiber increases stool bulk and prevents constipation.
- Beans, peas, and lentils are also rich sources of some vitamins and minerals, such as folate, iron, potassium and magnesium. Folate and iron are important for preventing anaemia, as well as maintaining normal metabolic functions. Potassium and magnesium are important for muscle and nerve function.



DO YOU KNOW...?

Spinach is the leaf, cauliflower is the flower and cucumber is the fruit. Some plants have medicinal value.

3.4 Purchase of vegetables and fruits

Most fresh vegetables and fruits retain their freshness for a short time under ideal conditions of storage. They belong to the category of perishables (green leafy vegetables) and semi - perishables (garlic, onion, roots and tubers) In general, freshness, uniformity of size, colour, degree of ripeness and being free from defects are the qualities most sought after while purchasing vegetables and fruits.

When purchasing, select fresh vegetables which are firm, crisp, bright in colour with no visible bruises or signs of decay and wilting.

Select clean leafy vegetables which are fresh,tender, crisp, brightly coloured and free from flowers, insects, mud and spots or holes in the leaves.

While selecting roots and tubers ensure that they are heavy, firm, free from sprouts, heavy in relation to size, with shallow eyes and without green discolouration.

At the peak of season, each vegetable and fruit has the highest nutrient content, flavour and is available at a reasonable price. It is therefore, advisable to buy vegetables and fruits which are in season, as the quality is good and the price is low.



ACTIVITY - 1

Visit a local market and indicate how you will purchase any five vegetables and fruits

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3.5 Vegetable Cookery

Vegetables are cooked to improve the colour, flavour and texture by which overall palatability is improved. Digestibility is also improved. The fibre becomes softened, starch gets gelatinised and protein gets coagulated. Cooking vegetables adds variety to the diet. Cooking also destroys micro-organisms.

While cooking vegetables, water-soluble nutrients like thiamine, riboflavin, nicotinic acid, pantothenic acid, pyridoxine, folic acid and vitamin C may be dissolved in the cooking water and the nutrients may be lost.

3.5.1 Methods to reduce loss of nutrient while cooking vegetables

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